# Reaper



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Paddy reaper

## What it is used for

A paddy reaper cuts mature rice stalks close to the ground and gathers them for collection. It reduces manual harvesting effort and helps improve harvesting efficiency under suitable field conditions.

## Main parts

- Identify the cutting blade or cutter bar used to sever the crop.
- Locate the crop divider that guides standing rice into the cutting area.
- Identify the reel, conveyor or gathering mechanism, depending on design.
- Locate the engine, power transmission and drive components.
- Identify the operator handles, steering controls and speed control.
- Locate the cutting-height adjustment and protective guards.
- Identify the emergency stop, transport lock and manufacturer's instructions.

## Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and receive supervised training before use.
2. Inspect blades, guards, fasteners, belts and drive components for damage.
3. Check fuel, engine oil and other specified fluids on engine-powered models.
4. Confirm that the crop is suitable for reaping and the field is accessible.
5. Inspect the field for stones, wires, people and other hidden hazards.
6. Check tyre or wheel condition and verify that operating controls work correctly.
7. Wear suitable footwear, eye protection and close-fitting work clothing.

## How to use

1. Park the reaper on level ground and stop the engine before inspection.
2. Adjust the cutting height according to crop and field conditions.
3. Check that all guards are fitted and the cutting area is clear.
4. Start the engine using the prescribed procedure.
5. Move to the crop at a safe, controlled speed.
6. Engage the cutting and gathering mechanisms according to instructions.
7. Guide the reaper through the crop using steady forward movement.
8. Monitor cutting quality and the flow of gathered stalks.
9. Stop safely if the blades clog or crop material becomes entangled.
10. Disengage the cutting mechanism before turning or transporting the machine.
11. Park on stable ground, lower attachments where applicable and stop the engine.

## ⚠ Safety

- Keep hands and feet away from the cutter bar and moving gathering parts.
- Never clear entangled stalks while the engine or blades are running.
- Stop the engine and isolate the drive before adjustments or cleaning.
- Keep bystanders away from the cutting path and discharge area.
- Refuel only after the engine is switched off and has cooled.
- Do not operate the reaper with missing guards or faulty controls.

## Care & storage

- Remove crop residue and soil after stopping and safely isolating the machine.
- Inspect blades, belts, fasteners and guards for wear or damage.
- Sharpen or replace cutting blades according to manufacturer instructions.
- Store the reaper in a dry, secure location with cutting parts protected.

## Common mistakes to avoid

- Operating with dull blades that tear or leave stalks uncut.
- Driving too quickly through lodged or uneven crop sections.
- Clearing tangled stalks without stopping and isolating the drive.
- Ignoring damaged guards, loose fasteners or abnormal machine vibration.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*



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